UNIT 17.2 · LEVEL A2

Adverb clauses of time – when / while

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 _____ I was walking home, it started to rain.

a) Because **b)** But **c)** While **d)** Or

2 I was sleeping _____ the phone rang.

a) when **b)** because **c)** but **d)** or

3 She was cooking _____ he was watching TV.

a) because **b)** but **c)** so **d)** while

4 _____ I arrived, they were having dinner.

a) While **b)** When **c)** Because **d)** But

5 He fell _____ he was running.

a) because **b)** while **c)** but **d)** so

6 Which sentence is correct?

a) While I studied was, he sleeping.
b) While I was study, he was sleeping.
c) While I was studying he sleeping.
d) While I was studying, he was sleeping.

7 When the teacher came in, the students _____.

a) were talking **b)** talk **c)** talks **d)** are talking

8 I _____ a shower when the phone rang.

a) am taking **b)** take **c)** was taking **d)** takes

9 What was she doing _____ you called?

a) because **b)** but **c)** so **d)** when

10 Which sentence is correct?

a) When I got home, my mother was cooking.
b) When I got home, my mother cooking.
c) While I got home, my mother cooked was.
d) When I was got home, my mother cooked.

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Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 _____ I was walking, it started to rain.

12 I was sleeping _____ the phone rang.

13 She was cooking _____ he was watching TV.

14 _____ I arrived, they were having dinner.

15 I was taking a shower _____ the doorbell rang.

16 They were talking _____ the teacher came in.

17 _____ he was driving, he was listening to music.

18 I _____ (read) when you called.

19 When she arrived, we _____ (have) lunch.

20 While they _____ (play), it started to rain.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **while / I / was / walking / it / started / to / rain**

_____

22 **was / sleeping / I / the / phone / when / rang**

_____

23 **cooking / she / was / he / while / was / watching / TV**

_____

24 **arrived / when / I / having / dinner / were / they**

_____

25 **came / when / in / the / teacher / talking / were / students / the**

_____

26 **shower / was / I / taking / a / rang / when / the / phone**

_____

27 **listening / driving / he / while / was / was / he / music / to**

_____

28 **called / when / was / you / I / reading**

_____

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Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the connector.*
_____ I was walking, it started to rain.
Options: **While** / **Because** / **But**

30 *Choose the connector.*
I was sleeping _____ the phone rang.
Options: **when** / **because** / **but**

31 *Choose the connector.*
She was cooking _____ he was watching TV.
Options: **while** / **because** / **but**

32 *Choose the connector.*
_____ I arrived, they were having dinner.
Options: **When** / **While** / **Because**

33 *Choose the verb.*
I was reading when you _____ .
Options: **called** / **were calling** / **calling**

34 *Choose the verb.*
When she called, I _____ TV.
Options: **was watching** / **were watching** / **am watching**

35 *Choose the verb.*
While he was driving, he _____ to music.
Options: **was listening** / **were listening** / **is listening**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each connector to its use.

1. while _____	**A.** one action interrupts another
2. when _____	**B.** shows contrast
3. because _____	**C.** two actions at the same time
4. but _____	**D.** gives a reason

37 Match each beginning to its ending.

1. I was sleeping when _____	**A.** it started to rain.
2. She was cooking while _____	**B.** the phone rang.
3. When I arrived _____	**C.** he was watching TV.
4. While I was walking _____	**D.** they were having dinner.

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38 Match each word to its job.

1. was walking _____
2. started _____
3. while _____
4. when _____

A. introduces a short action
B. introduces a longer action
C. short action that interrupts
D. longer action in progress

39 Match each question to an answer.

1. What were you doing when I called? _____
2. What was she doing while you were working? _____
3. What happened while you were walking? _____
4. What were they doing when you arrived? _____

A. She was cooking.
B. It started to rain.
C. They were having dinner.
D. I was reading.

40 Match each beginning to its ending.

1. While he was driving, _____
2. When the teacher came in, _____
3. I was taking a shower when _____
4. She was crying when _____

A. the doorbell rang.
B. he was listening to music.
C. I saw her.
D. the students were talking.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 While I was walk home, it started to rain.
Correct word: _____

42 I was sleeping while the phone rang. Correct word: _____

43 When I was arrived, they were eating. Correct word: _____

44 She was cook while he was watching TV. Correct word: _____

45 When the teacher came in, the students was talking.
Correct word: _____

46 While I were studying, he was sleeping. Correct word: _____

47 I was taking a shower while the doorbell rang.
Correct word: _____

48 When she called, I was watch TV. Correct word: _____

49 While he was drive, he was listening to music.
Correct word: _____

50 They were talking when the teacher come in.
Correct word: _____

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Answer Key

Adverb clauses of time – when / while

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** While	'While' + longer action in progress.
2	**a)** when	'When' + short action that interrupts.
3	**d)** while	'While' joins two actions at the same time.
4	**b)** When	'When' + short action (arrived).
5	**b)** while	'While' + longer action in progress.
6	**d)** While I was studying, he was sleeping.	While + past continuous.
7	**a)** were talking	The longer action uses past continuous.
8	**c)** was taking	The longer action uses past continuous.
9	**d)** when	'When' + short action (called).
10	**a)** When I got home, my mother was cooking.	When + past simple, past continuous.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**While**	'While' + longer action.
12	**when**	'When' + short action.
13	**while**	Two actions at the same time.
14	**When**	'When' + short action.
15	**when**	'When' + short action.
16	**when**	'When' + short action.
17	**While**	Two actions at the same time.
18	**was reading**	Longer action: was + verb-ing.
19	**were having**	Longer action: were + verb-ing.
20	**were playing**	Longer action: were + verb-ing.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**While I was walking it started to rain.**	While + past continuous.
22	**I was sleeping when the phone rang.**	when + short action.
23	**She was cooking while he was watching TV.**	while + past continuous.
24	**When I arrived they were having dinner.**	When + past simple.
25	**When the teacher came in the students were talking.**	When + past simple.

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26	**I was taking a shower when the phone rang.**	when + short action.
27	**While he was driving he was listening to music.**	while + past continuous.
28	**I was reading when you called.**	when + short action.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**While**	'While' + longer action.
30	**when**	'When' + short action.
31	**while**	Two actions at the same time.
32	**When**	'When' + short action.
33	**called**	Short action: past simple.
34	**was watching**	Longer action: past continuous.
35	**was listening**	Longer action: past continuous.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	while – two actions at the same time; when – one action interrupts another; because – gives a reason; but – shows contrast Each connector has its own job.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	I was sleeping when – the phone rang.; She was cooking while – he was watching TV.; When I arrived – they were having dinner.; While I was walking – it started to rain. Choose the logical ending.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	was walking – longer action in progress; started – short action that interrupts; while – introduces a longer action; when – introduces a short action Longer actions: past continuous.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	What were you doing when I called? – I was reading.; What was she doing while you were working? – She was cooking.; What happened while you were walking? – It started to rain.; What were they doing when you arrived? – They were having dinner. Answer with past continuous or past simple.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	While he was driving, – he was listening to music.; When the teacher came in, – the students were talking.; I was taking a shower when – the doorbell rang.; She was crying when – I saw her. Choose the logical ending.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**walking**	After 'was' use verb-ing.
42	**when**	A short action uses 'when'.
43	**arrived**	Use past simple for the short action.
44	**cooking**	After 'was' use verb-ing.
45	**were**	'Students' goes with 'were'.
46	**was**	'I' goes with 'was'.
47	**when**	A short action uses 'when'.
48	**watching**	After 'was' use verb-ing.
49	**driving**	After 'was' use verb-ing.

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50	**came**	Use past simple for the short action.

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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